

Crime in the United States

Crime in the United States has been recorded since the early 1600s. Crime rates have varied over time, with a sharp rise after 1900 and reaching a broad bulging peak between the 1970s and early 1990s. After 1991, crime rates began to fall year by year and has since declined significantly. This trend lasted until 2015, where crime rates began to rise slightly. This reversed in 2018 and 2019, but violent crime increased significantly again in 2020.^{[2][3]} Despite the increase in violent crime, particularly murders, between 2020 and 2021, the quantity of overall crime is still far below the peak of crime seen in the United States during the late 1980s and early 1990s, as other crimes such as rape, property crime and robbery continued to decline.^{[4][5]} The aggregate cost of crime in the United States remains high, with an estimated value of \$4.9 trillion reported in 2021.^[6]

Statistics on specific crimes are indexed in the annual Uniform Crime Reports by the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) and by annual National Crime Victimization Surveys by the Bureau of Justice Statistics. In addition to the primary Uniform Crime Report known as *Crime in the United States*, the FBI publishes annual reports on the status of law enforcement in the United States. The report's definitions of specific crimes are considered standard by many American law enforcement agencies. According to the FBI, index crime in the United States includes violent crime and property crime. Violent crime consists of five criminal offenses: murder and non-negligent manslaughter, rape, robbery, aggravated assault, and gang violence; property crime consists of burglary, larceny, motor vehicle theft, and arson.

The basic aspect of a crime considers the offender, the victim, type of crime, severity and level, and location. These are the basic questions asked by law enforcement when first investigating any situation. This information is formatted into a government record by a police arrest report, also known as an incident report. These forms lay out all the information needed to put the crime in the system and it provides a strong outline for further law enforcement agents to review. Society has a strong misconception about crime rates due to media aspects heightening their fear factor.^[7] The system's crime data fluctuates by crime depending on certain influencing social factors such as economics, the dark figure of crime, population, and geography.^[7]

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Violent crimes	
<u>Homicide</u>	6.5
<u>Rape</u>	38.4
<u>Robbery</u>	73.9
<u>Aggravated assault</u>	279.7
<u>Total violent crime</u>	398.5
Property crimes	
<u>Burglary</u>	314.2
<u>Larceny-theft</u>	1,398
<u>Motor vehicle theft</u>	246
<u>Total property crime</u>	1,958.2
Notes	
*Number of reported crimes per 100,000 population.	
Estimated total population: 329,500,000.	
In 2013 the FBI modified the definition of rape.	
Source: ^[1] Federal Bureau of Investigation Crime Data Explorer	



Police vehicles in the New York City, US

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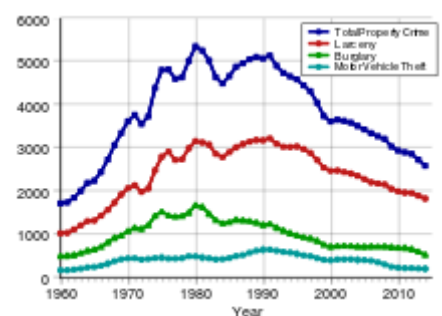
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Crime over time

In the long term, violent crime in the United States has been in decline since colonial times. The homicide rate has been estimated to be over 30 per 100,000 people in 1700, dropping to under 20 by 1800, and to under 10 by 1900.^[8]

After World War II, crime rates increased in the United States, peaking from the 1970s to the early-1990s. Violent crime nearly quadrupled between 1960 and its peak in 1991. Property crime more than doubled over the same period. Since the 1990s, however, contrary to common misconception,^[9] crime in the United States has declined steadily, and has significantly declined by the late 1990s and also in the early 2000s. Several theories have been proposed to explain this decline:

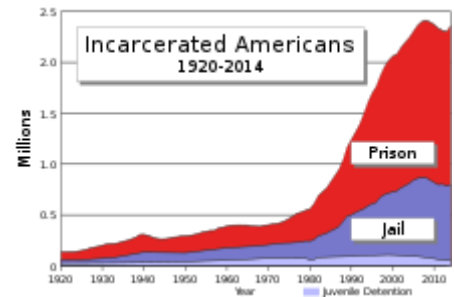


Property crime rates in the United States per 100,000 population beginning in 1960. Source: Bureau of Justice Statistics.

- The number of police officers hired and employed to various police forces increased considerably in the 1990s.^[10]
- On September 16, 1994, President Bill Clinton signed the Violent Crime Control and Law Enforcement Act into law. Under the act, over \$30 billion in federal aid was spent over a six-year period to improve state and local law enforcement, prisons and crime prevention

programs. Proponents of the law, including the President, touted it as a lead contributor to the sharp drop in crime which occurred throughout the 1990s, while critics have dismissed it as an unprecedented federal boondoggle.^[11]

- The prison population has rapidly increased since the mid-1970s.^[10]
- Starting in the mid-1980s, the crack-cocaine market grew rapidly before declining again a decade later. Some authors have pointed towards the link between violent crimes and crack use.^[10]
- Legalized abortion reduced the number of children born to mothers in difficult circumstances, and difficult childhood makes children more likely to become criminals.^[12]
- The changing demographics of an aging population has been cited for the drop in overall crime.^[13]
- Rising income^[14]
- The introduction of the data-driven policing practice CompStat significantly reduced crimes in cities that adopted it.^[14]
- The lead-crime hypothesis suggests reduced lead exposure as the cause; Scholar Mark A.R. Kleiman writes: "Given the decrease in lead exposure among children since the 1980s and the estimated effects of lead on crime, reduced lead exposure could easily explain a very large proportion—certainly more than half—of the crime decrease of the 1994–2004 period. A careful statistical study relating local changes in lead exposure to local crime rates estimates the fraction of the crime decline due to lead reduction as greater than 90 percent."^[15]
- The quality and extent of use of security technology both increased around the time of the crime decline, after which the rate of car theft declined; this may have caused rates of other crimes to decline as well.^[16]
- Increased rates of immigration to the United States^{[17][18]}



Total incarceration in the United States by year

Violent crime rates (per 100,000) in the United States (1960-2018):^{[19][20]}

Year	Violent crime	Murder and non-negligent manslaughter	<u>Rape</u>	Robbery	Aggravated assault
1960	160.9	5.1	9.6	60.1	86.1
1961	158.1	4.8	9.4	58.3	85.7
1962	162.3	4.6	9.4	59.7	88.6
1963	168.2	4.6	9.4	61.8	92.4
1964	190.6	4.9	11.2	68.2	106.2
1965	200.2	5.1	12.1	71.7	111.3
1966	220.0	5.6	13.2	80.8	120.3
1967	253.2	6.2	14.0	102.8	130.2
1968	298.4	6.9	15.9	131.8	143.8
1969	328.7	7.3	18.5	148.4	154.5
1970	363.5	7.9	18.7	172.1	164.8
1971	396.0	8.6	20.5	188.0	178.8
1972	401.0	9.0	22.5	180.7	188.8
1973	417.4	9.4	24.5	183.1	200.5
1974	461.1	9.8	26.2	209.3	215.8
1975	487.8	9.6	26.3	220.8	231.1
1976	467.8	8.7	26.6	199.3	233.2
1977	475.9	8.8	29.4	190.7	247.0
1978	497.8	9.0	31.0	195.8	262.1
1979	548.9	9.8	34.7	218.4	286.0
1980	596.6	10.2	36.8	251.1	298.5
1981	594.3	9.8	36.0	258.4	289.3
1982	570.8	9.1	34.0	238.8	289.0
1983	537.7	8.3	33.8	216.7	279.4
1984	539.9	7.9	35.7	205.7	290.6
1985	556.6	8.0	36.8	209.3	304.0
1986	620.1	8.6	38.1	226.0	347.4
1987	612.5	8.3	37.6	213.7	352.9
1988	640.6	8.5	37.8	222.1	372.2
1989	666.9	8.7	38.3	234.3	385.6
1990	729.6	9.4	41.1	256.3	422.9
1991	758.2	9.8	42.3	272.7	433.4
1992	757.7	9.3	42.8	263.7	441.9
1993	747.1	9.5	41.1	256.0	440.5
1994	713.6	9.0	39.3	237.8	427.6
1995	684.5	8.2	37.1	220.9	418.3

1996	636.6	7.4	36.3	201.9	391.0
1997	611.0	6.8	35.9	186.2	382.1
1998	567.6	6.3	34.5	165.5	361.4
1999	523.0	5.7	32.8	150.1	334.3
2000	506.5	5.5	32.0	145.0	324.0
2001	504.5	5.6	31.8	148.5	318.6
2002	494.4	5.6	33.1	146.1	309.5
2003	475.8	5.7	32.3	142.5	295.4
2004	463.2	5.5	32.4	136.7	288.6
2005	469.0	5.6	31.8	140.8	290.8
2006	473.6	5.8	31.6	150.0	292.0
2007	471.8	5.7	30.6	148.3	287.2
2008	458.6	5.4	29.8	145.9	277.5
2009	431.9	5.0	29.1	133.1	264.7
2010	404.5	4.8	27.7	119.3	252.8
2011	387.1	4.7	27.0	113.9	241.5
2012	387.8	4.7	27.1	113.1	242.8
2013	369.1	4.5	25.9	109.0	229.6
2014	361.6	4.4	26.6	101.3	229.2
2015	373.7	4.9	28.4	102.2	238.1
2016	386.6	5.4	30.0	102.9	248.3
2017	383.8	5.3	30.7	98.6	249.2
2018	368.9	5.0	30.9	86.2	246.8

Property crime rates (per 100,000) in the United States (1960–2018):^{[19][20]}

Year	Property crime	Burglary	Larceny	Motor vehicle theft
1960	1,726.3			
1961	1,747.9			
1963	2,012			
1965	2,249			
1967	2,736			
1969	3,351			
1971	3,769			
1973	3,737			
1975	4,811			
1977	4,602			
1979	5,017			
1981	5,264			
1983	4,637			
1985	4,650			
1987	4,940			
1989	5,078			
1991	5,140			
1992	4,903.7	1,168.4	3,103.6	631.6
1993	4,740.0	1,099.7	3,033.9	606.3
1994	4,660.2	1,042.1	3,026.9	591.3
1995	4,590.5	987.0	3,043.2	560.3
1996	4,451.0	945.0	2,980.3	525.7
1997	4,316.3	918.8	2,891.8	505.7
1998	4,052.5	863.2	2,729.5	459.9
1999	3,743.6	770.4	2,550.7	422.5
2000	3,618.3	728.8	2,477.3	412.2
2001	3,658.1	741.8	2,485.7	430.5
2002	3,630.6	747.0	2,450.7	432.9
2003	3,591.2	741.0	2,416.5	433.7
2004	3,514.1	730.3	2,362.3	421.5
2005	3,431.5	726.9	2,287.8	416.8
2006	3,346.6	733.1	2,213.2	400.2
2007	3,276.4	726.1	2,185.4	364.9
2008	3,214.6	733.0	2,166.1	315.4
2009	3,041.3	717.7	2,064.5	259.2
2010	2,945.9	701.0	2,005.8	239.1
2011	2,905.4	701.3	1,974.1	230.0

2012	2,868.0	672.2	1,965.4	230.4
2013	2,733.6	610.5	1,901.9	221.3
2014	2,574.1	537.2	1,821.5	215.4
2015	2,500.5	494.7	1,783.6	222.2
2016	2,451.6	468.9	1,745.4	237.3
2017	2,362.9	429.7	1,695.5	237.7
2018	2,199.5	376.0	1,594.6	228.9

Arrests

Each state has a set of statutes enforceable within its own borders. A state has no jurisdiction outside of its borders, even though still in the United States. It must request extradition from the state in which the suspect has fled. In 2014, there were 186,873 misdemeanor suspects outside specific states jurisdiction against whom no extradition would be sought. Philadelphia has about 20,000 of these since it is near a border with four other states. Extradition is estimated to cost a few hundred dollars per case.^[21]

Analysis of arrest data from California indicates that the most common causes of felony arrest are for violent offenses such as robbery and assault, property offenses such as burglary and auto theft, and drug offenses. For misdemeanors, the most common causes of arrest were traffic offenses, most notably impaired driving, drug offenses, and failure to appear in court. Other common causes of misdemeanor arrest included assault and battery and minor property offenses such as petty theft.^[22]

Characteristics of offenders

According to the National Crime Victimization Survey (NCVS) from 2018 to 2019 there was a 19% decline in reported serious crimes, with 880,000 fewer people victimized in 2019.^{[23][2]} From 2018 to 2019 the rate of property crime decreased 6%. This is a decline of 6.8 victimizations per 1,000 households.^[24] Violent victimization based on race and ethnicity from the years 2005 to 2019 have dropped by 26% overall. The rate for white individuals fell 24%. The rate for black individuals fell 43%.^[25]

Arrested Offenders by Race (2019)

Year	White	Black	American Indian or Alaskan Native	Asian or Pacific Islander
2019	7,014,550	2,667,010	244,200	159,450
Violent Crime	276,310	172,980	11,110	10,480
Property Crime	717,390	320,270	20,450	16,260

Arrested Offenders by Gender (2019)

Year	Male	Female
2019	5,012,260	1,905,292
Violent Crime	367,350	103,540
Property Crime	671,920	402,450

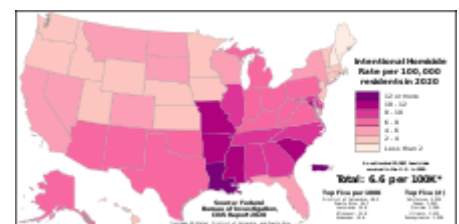
Characteristics of offenders vary from the average for specific types of crimes and specific crimes. In terms of violent crime by gender, in 2019, 78.9% of arrested persons were male and 21.1% were female.^[26] Males were 88.0% of those arrested for homicide, while females were 12.0%.^[26] Among those arrested for rape in 2019, males were 96.6% and females were 3.4%.^[26] For property crime in 2019, 62.3% of arrested persons were male and 37.7% were female.^[26]

For violent crime by race in 2019, 59.1% of those arrested were White, 36.4% were Black, 2.3% were American Indian or Alaska Native, 1.6% were Asian, and 0.6% were Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander.^[27] For persons arrested for homicide in 2019, 45.8% were White, 51.2% were Black, 1.6% were American Indian or Alaska Native, 1.0% were Asian, and 0.4% were Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander.^[27] For persons arrested for rape in 2019, 69.8% were White, 26.7% were Black, 1.5% were American Indian or Alaska Native, 1.7% were Asian, and 0.4% were Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander.^[27] For property crime in 2019, 66.8% of arrested persons were White, 29.8% were Black, 1.9% were American Indian or Alaska Native, 1.2% were Asian, and 0.3% were Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander.^[27]

Behaviors of Offender

Typical characteristics of offenders that are supported by the public are those that suffer from a mental illness or drug addiction, offenders younger than 20–30, offenders older than 30, female offenders, and those of a racial or ethnic majority group. Offender occupation status and legality are also leading affective.^[29]

Factors that may motivate an offender to act on their instincts can depend on their surrounding environment. This could include the number of people in the area, the class level of the area, amount of law enforcement in a public area.^[30] There are also other factors that may motivate an offender aside from their surrounding such as prior trauma, psychological damage, and biological factors.^[30]



The map above shows the intentional homicide rate in each state (per 100,000 residents) of the United States and the District of Columbia. Data comes from the FBI's Uniform Crime Report 2019.^[28]

Crime Type and Severity

People are more likely to fear and be less sympathetic toward offenders with a violent criminal history.^[29] Violent criminal history includes any offense, of the severity of a violent felony, such as rape, homicide, aggravated assault, and robbery.^[31] People associate these criminals with a negative connotation especially in comparison to those with a non-violent, non-sexual, criminal history, offenses with a misdemeanor severity level.^[29]

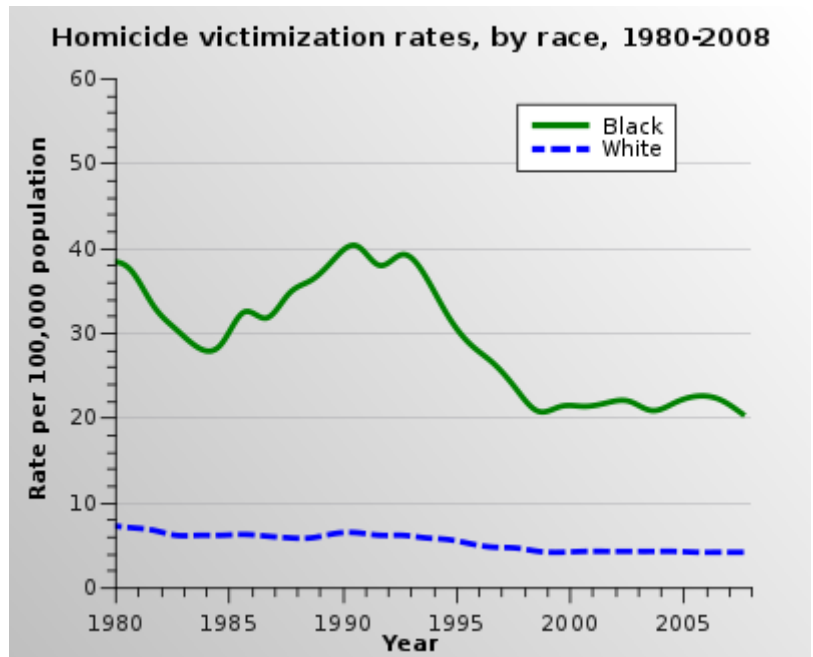
Crime victimology

In 2011, surveys indicated more than 5.8 million violent victimizations and 17.1 million property victimizations took place in the United States; according to the Bureau of Justice Statistics, each property victimization corresponded to one household, while violent victimizations is the number of victims of a violent crime.^[33]

Patterns are found within the victimology of crime in the United States. Overall, people with lower incomes, those younger than 25, and non-whites were more likely to report being the victim of crime.^[33] Income, gender, and age had the most dramatic effect on the chances of a person being victimized by crime,

while the characteristic of race depended upon the crime being committed.^[33]

In terms of gender, the BJS National Crime Victimization Survey (NCVS) published in 2019 that "the percentage of violent victimizations reported to police was higher for females (46%) than for males (36%)". This difference can largely be attributed to reporting of simple assaults, as the percentages of violent victimizations reported to police, excluding simple assault, were similar for females (47%) and males (46%). The victim-to-population ratio of 1.0 for both males and females shows that the percentage of violent incidents involving male (49%) or female (51%) victims was equal to males' (49%) or females' (51%) share of the population.^[34]



This graph shows the homicide victimization rate for whites and blacks, according to the US Bureau of Justice Statistics.^[32]

In regards to rape, the National Incident-Based Reporting System (NIBRS) indicates females are disproportionately more affected than males. According to the data collected from 2010 to 2020, women make 89% of victims of rape, while men make 11%. Perpetrators are 93% men.^[35]

Concerning age, those younger than twenty-five were more likely to fall victim to crime, especially violent crime.^[36] The chances of being victimized by violent crime decreased far more substantially with age than the chances of becoming the victim of property crime.^[36] For example, 3.03% of crimes committed against a young person were theft, while 20% of crimes committed against an elderly person were theft.^[36]

Bias motivation reports showed that of the 7,254 hate crimes reported in 2011, 47.7% (3,465) were motivated by race, with 72% (2,494) of race-motivated incidents being anti-black.^[37] In addition, 20.8% (1,508) of hate crimes were motivated by sexual orientation, with 57.8% (871) of orientation-motivated incidents being anti-male homosexual.^[37] The third largest motivation factor for hate crime was religion, representing 18.2% (1,318) incidents, with 62.2% (820) of religion-motivated incidents being anti-Jewish.^[37]

As of 2007, violent crime against homeless people is increasing.^[38]

The likelihood of falling victim to crime relates to both demographic and geographic characteristics.^[39]

In 2010, according to the UNODC, 67.5% of all homicides in the United States were perpetrated using a firearm.^[40] The costliest crime in terms of total financial impact on all of its victims, and the most underreported crime is rape, in the United States.^{[41][42]}

Incarceration

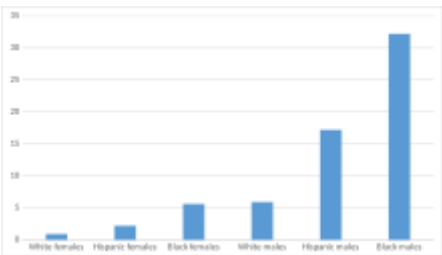
The United States has the highest incarceration rate in the world (which includes pre-trial detainees and sentenced prisoners).^[43] As of 2009, 2.3 million people were incarcerated in the United States, including federal and state prisons and local jails, creating an incarceration rate of 793 persons per 100,000 of

national population.^[43] During 2011, 1.6 million people were incarcerated under the jurisdiction of federal and state authorities.^[44] At the end of 2011, 492 persons per 100,000 U.S. residents were incarcerated in federal and state prisons.^[44] Of the 1.6 million state and federal prisoners, nearly 1.4 million people were under state jurisdiction, while 215,000 were under federal jurisdiction.^[44] Demographically, nearly 1.5 million prisoners were male, and 115,000 were female, while 581,000 prisoners were black, 516,000 were white, and 350,000 were Hispanic.^[44]

Among the 1.35 million sentenced state prisoners in 2011, 725,000 people were incarcerated for violent crimes, 250,000 were incarcerated for property crimes, 237,000 people were incarcerated for drug crimes, and 150,000 were incarcerated for other offenses.^[44] Of the 200,000 sentenced federal prisoners in 2011, 95,000 were incarcerated for drug crimes, 69,000 were incarcerated for public order offenses, 15,000 were incarcerated for violent crimes, and 11,000 were incarcerated for property crimes.^[44]



A map of U.S. states by incarceration rate under state prison jurisdiction (but excluding jail and federal prison inmates) per 100,000 population.



As of 2001, the lifetime likelihood of ever going to prison for various demographic groups, by percentages



Felony Sentences in State Courts, study by the United States Department of Justice.

International comparison

The manner in which America's crime rate compared to other countries of similar wealth and development depends on the nature of the crime used in the comparison.^[45] Overall crime statistic comparisons are difficult to conduct, as the definition and categorization of crimes varies across countries. Thus an agency in a foreign country may include crimes in its annual reports which the United States omits, and vice versa.

However, some countries such as Canada have similar definitions of what constitutes a violent crime, and nearly all countries had the same definition of the characteristics that constitutes a homicide. Overall the total crime rate of the United States is higher than developed countries, specifically Europe and East Asia, with South American countries and Russia being the exceptions.^[46] Some types of reported property crime in the U.S. survey as lower than in Germany or Canada, yet the homicide rate in the United States is substantially higher as is the prison population.

The difference in homicide rate between the US and other high income countries has widened in recent years especially since the 30% rise in 2020 was not replicated elsewhere, and is also above many developing countries such as China, India and Turkey.^[47] In the European Union, homicides fell 32% between 2008-2019 to 3,875^[48] while rising by 4,901 in the US in 2020 alone,^[49] leaving the US with a homicide rate 7x higher. In reputable estimates of crime across the globe, the US generally ranks slightly below the middle - roughly 70th lowest or 100th highest.^{[50][51]}

Violent crime

The reported U.S. violent crime rate includes murder, rape and sexual assault, robbery, and assault,^[52] whereas the Canadian violent crime rate includes all categories of assault, including Assault level 1 (i.e., assault not using a weapon and not resulting in serious bodily harm).^{[53][54]} A Canadian government study concluded that direct comparison of the two countries' violent crime totals or rates was "inappropriate".^[55]

France does not count minor violence such as punching or slapping as assault, whereas Austria, Germany, Finland and the United Kingdom do count such occurrences.^[56]

The United Kingdom similarly has different definitions of what constitutes violent crime compared to the United States, making a direct comparison of the overall figure flawed. The FBI's Uniform Crime Reports defines a "violent crime" as one of four specific offenses: murder and non-negligent manslaughter, forcible rape, robbery, and aggravated assault. The British Home Office, by contrast, has a different definition of violent crime, including all "crimes against the person", including simple assaults, all robberies, and all "sexual offenses", as opposed to the FBI, which only counts aggravated assaults and "forcible rapes".^[57]

Crime rates are necessarily altered by averaging neighborhood higher or lower local rates over a larger population which includes the entire city. Having small pockets of dense crime may increase a city's average crime rate.

Police-recorded violent crime rates per 100,000 population^{[58][59][60][61]}

Country	Homicide	Rape	Sexual assault	Robbery	Assault
Australia	1.2	— †	80.0 ²⁰¹² ^[59] †	18	327
Germany	0.8	9.4 ²⁰¹⁰	56.9 ²⁰¹⁰	60	630
England/Wales	1.1	28.8 ²⁰¹⁰	82.1 ²⁰¹⁰	137	730
Scotland	1.6	17.0 ²⁰⁰⁹	124.6 ²⁰⁰⁹	48	1487
US	5.0	44.4 ²⁰¹⁸ UCR ^[62]	270.0 ²⁰¹⁸ NCVS ^[63] ^	133	241
Sweden	1.0	63.5 ²⁰¹⁰	183.0 ²⁰¹⁰	103	927

† Australian statistics record only sexual assault, and do not have separate statistics for rape only. Sexual assault is defined to include rape, attempted rape, aggravated sexual assault (assault with a weapon), indecent assault, penetration by objects, forced sexual activity that did not end in penetration and attempts to force a person into sexual activity; but excludes unwanted sexual touching. ^[64]

^ UCR rape statistics do NOT include sexual assault, while the NCVS does, furthermore NCVS define sexual assault to include as well sexual touching with/without force, and verbal threats of rape or sexual assault, as well as rape, attempted rape, and sexual assault that isn't rape.^{[60][61]}

Homicide

According to a 2013 report by the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), between 2005 and 2012, the average homicide rate in the U.S. was 4.9 per 100,000 inhabitants compared to the average rate globally, which was 6.2. However, the U.S. had much higher murder rates compared to four other selected "developed countries", which all had average homicide rates of 0.8 per 100,000.^[46] In 2004, there were 5.5 homicides for every 100,000 persons, roughly three times as high as Canada (1.9) and six times as high as Germany and Italy (0.9).^{[65][53]} A closer look at The National Archive of Criminal Justice Data indicates that *per capita* homicide rates over the last 30 plus years on average, of major cities, New Orleans'

average annual *per capita* homicide rate of 52 murders per 100,000 people overall (1980–2012) is the highest of U.S. cities with average annual homicide totals that were among the top 10 highest during the same period.

In 2018, the US murder rate was 5.0 per 100,000, for a total of 15,498 murders.^[66]



The historical homicide rate in the U.S. from 1900–2001

Country	Singapore	Iceland	Armenia	United States	Moldova	South Sudan	Panama
Homicide rate (per hundred thousand) (international methodology) ^[46]	0.2	0.5	1.7	5.1	5.2	12	53.1

In the United States, the number of homicides where the victim and offender relationship was undetermined has been increasing since 1999 but has not reached the levels experienced in the early 1990s. In 14% of all murders, the victim and the offender were strangers. Spouses and family members made up about 15% of all victims, about one-third of the victims were acquaintances of the assailant, and the victim and offender relationship was undetermined in over one-third of homicides. Gun involvement in homicides were gang-related homicides which increased after 1980, homicides that occurred during the commission of a felony which increased from 55% in 1985 to 77% in 2005, homicides resulting from arguments which declined to the lowest levels recorded recently, and homicides resulting from other circumstances which remained relatively constant. Because gang killing has become a normal part of inner cities, many including police hold preconceptions about the causes of death in inner cities. When a death is labeled gang-related it lowers the chances that it will be investigated and increases the chances that the perpetrator will remain at large. In addition, victims of gang killings often determine the priority a case will be given by police. Jenkins (1988) argues that many serial murder cases remain unknown to police and that cases involving Black offenders and victims are especially likely to escape official attention.^[67]

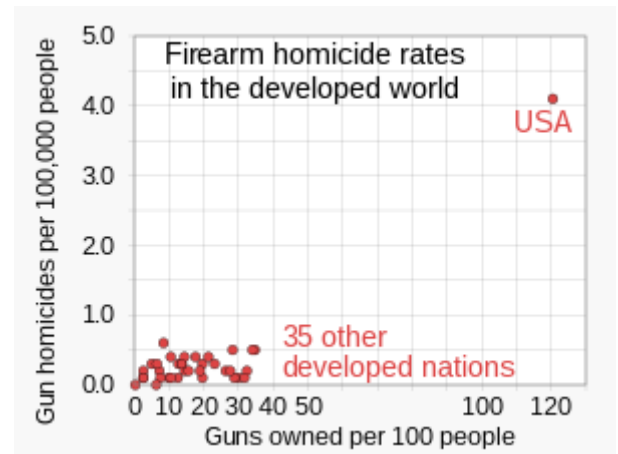
According to the FBI, "When the race of the offender was known, 53.0 percent were black, 44.7 percent were white, and 2.3 percent were of other races. The race was unknown for 4,132 offenders. (Based on Expanded Homicide Data Table 3 (https://www.fbi.gov/about-us/cjis/ucr/crime-in-the-u.s/2014/crime-in-the-u.s.-2014/tables/expanded-homicide-data/expanded_homicide_data_table_3_murder_offenders_by_age_sex_and_race_2014.xls)). Of the offenders for whom gender was known, 88.2 percent were male."^[68] According to the U.S. Bureau of Justice Statistics, from 1980 to 2008, 84 percent of white homicide victims were killed by white offenders and 93 percent of black homicide victims were killed by black offenders.^[32]

Gun violence

The United States has the highest rate of civilian gun ownership per capita.^{[70][71][72]} According to the CDC, between 1999 and 2014 there have been 185,718 homicides from use of a firearm and 291,571 suicides using a firearm.^[73] Despite a significant increase in the sales of firearms since 1994, the US has seen a drop in the annual rate of homicides using a firearm from 7.0 per 100,000 population in 1993 to 3.6 per 100,000.^[74] In the ten years between 2000 and 2009, the ATF reported 37,372,713 clearances for purchase, however, in the four years between 2010 and 2013, the ATF reported 31,421,528 clearances.^[75]

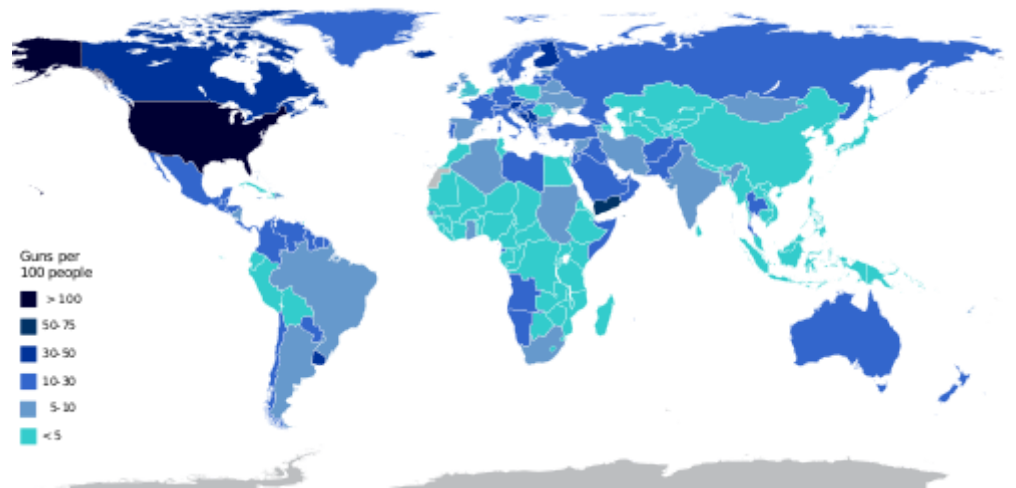
Property crime

According to a 2004 study by the Bureau of Justice Statistics, looking at the period from 1981 to 1999, the United States had a lower surveyed residential burglary rate in 1998 than Scotland, England, Canada, the Netherlands, and Australia. The other two countries included in the study, Sweden and Switzerland, had only slightly lower burglary rates. For the first nine years of the study period the same surveys of the public showed only Australia with rates higher than the United States. The authors noted various problems in doing the comparisons including infrequent data points. (The United States performed five surveys from 1995 to 1999 when its rate dipped below Canada's, while Canada ran a single telephone survey during that period for comparison.)^[45]

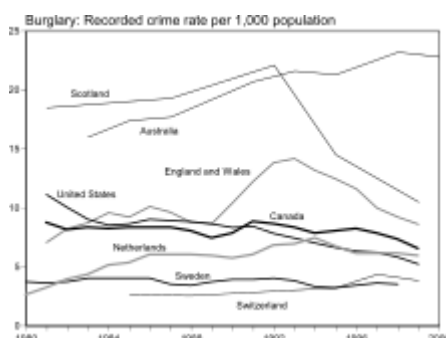


In 2019, the U.S. gun homicide rate was 18 times the average rate in other developed countries.^[69] Shown: gun homicide rate graphed versus gun ownership rate in developed countries.^[69]

Crimes against children



Map of civilian guns per capita by country to the "Small Arms Survey 2007"^[70]



The burglary rates of selected industrialized countries as published by the U.S. Bureau of Justice Statistics

Violence against children from birth to adolescence is considered a "global phenomenon that takes many forms (physical, sexual, emotional), and occurs in many settings, including the home, school, community, care, and justice systems, and over the Internet."^[76]

According to a 2001 report from UNICEF, the United States has the highest rate of deaths from child abuse and neglect of any industrialized nation, at 2.4 per 100,000 children; France has 1.4, Japan 1, UK 0.9 and Germany 0.8. According to the US Department of Health, the state of Texas has the highest death rate, at 4.1 per 100,000 children, New York has 2.5, Oregon 1.5 and New Hampshire 0.4. ^[77] A 2018 report from the Congressional Research Service stated, at the national level, violent crime and homicide rates have increased each year from 2014 to 2016.^[78]

In 2016, data from the National Child Abuse and Neglect Data System (NCANDS) revealed that approximately 1,750 children died from either abuse or neglect; further, this is a continuing trend with an increasing 7.4% of crimes against children from 2012 to 2016 and these statistics can be compared to a rate of 2.36 children per 100,000 children in the United States general population.^[79] In addition, 44.2% of these 2016 statistics are specific to physical abuse towards a child.^[79]

A 2016 report from the Child Welfare Information Gateway also showed that parents account for 78% of violence against children in the United States.

Human trafficking

Human trafficking is categorized into the following three groups: (1) sex trafficking; (2) sex and labor trafficking; and (3) labor trafficking; In addition, the rate of domestic minor sex trafficking has exponentially increased over the years. Sex trafficking of children also referred to as commercial sexual exploitation of children, is categorized by the following forms: pornography, prostitution, child sex tourism, and child marriage. Profiles of traffickers and types of trafficking differ in the way victims are abducted, how they are treated, and the reason for the abduction.

According to a 2017 report from the National Human Trafficking Hotline (NHTH), out of 10,615 reported survivors of sex trafficking, 2,762 of those survivors were minors.^[80]

The U.S. Department of Justice defines Commercial Sexual Exploitation of Children (CSEC) as a range of crimes and activities involving the sexual abuse or exploitation of a child for the financial benefit of any person or in exchange for anything of value (including monetary and non-monetary benefits) given or received by any person. These crimes against children, which may occur at any time or place, rob them of their childhood and are extremely detrimental to their emotional and psychological development.^[81]

Types of human sex trafficking

In Pimp-controlled trafficking, the pimp typically is the only trafficker involved who has full physical, psychological and emotional control over the victim. In Gang-controlled trafficking, a large group of people has power over the victim, forcing the victim to take part in illegal or violent tasks for the purpose of obtaining drugs. Another form is called Familial trafficking, which differs the most from the two mentioned above because the victim is typically not abducted. Instead, the victim is forced into being sexually exploited by family members in exchange for something of monetary value, whether that's paying back debt, or obtaining drugs or money. This type of sexual exploitation tends to be the most difficult to detect, yet remains as the most prevalent form of human sex trafficking within the United States.^[81]

In 2009, the Office of Juvenile Justice and Delinquency Prevention reported that the average age when children first fall victim to CSEC is between ages 12 and 14. However, this age has become increasingly younger due to exploiters' fear of contracting HIV or AIDS from older victims.^[81]

In 2018, the Office of Public Affairs within the Department of Justice released a report from operation "Broken Heart" conducted by Internet Crimes Against Children (ICAC) task forces, stating that more than 2,300 suspected online child sex offenders were arrested on the following allegations:^[82]

1. produce, distribute, receive and possess child pornography
2. engage in online enticement of children for sexual purposes
3. engage in the sex trafficking of children
4. travel across state lines or to foreign countries and sexually abuse children

In addition, a 2011 report by the Bureau of Justice Statistics described the characteristics of suspected human trafficking incidents, identifying roughly 95% of victims as female and over half as 17 years old or younger.

Geography of crime

Crime rates vary in the United States depending on the type of community.^[83] Within metropolitan statistical areas, both violent and property crime rates are higher than the national average; in cities located outside metropolitan areas, violent crime was lower than the national average, while property crime was higher.^[83] For rural areas, both property and violent crime rates were lower than the national average.^[83]

Regions

For regional comparisons, the FBI divides the United States into four regions: Northeast, Midwest, South, and West.^[84] For 2019, the region with the lowest violent crime rate was the Northeast, with a rate of 292.4 per 100,000 residents, while the region with the highest violent crime rate was the West, with a rate of 413.5 per 100,000.^[84] For 2019, the region with the lowest property crime rate was the Northeast, with a rate of 1,350.4 per 100,000 residents, while the region with the highest property crime rate was the West, with a rate of 2,411.7 per 100,000.^[84]

States

Crime rates vary among U.S. states.^[85] In 2019, the state with the lowest violent crime rate was Maine, with a rate of 115.2 per 100,000 residents, while the state with the highest violent crime rate was Alaska, with a rate of 867.1 per 100,000.^[85] However, the District of Columbia, the U.S. capital district, had a violent crime rate of 1,049.0 per 100,000 in 2019.^[85] In 2019, the state with the highest property crime rate was Louisiana, with a rate of 3,162.0 per 100,000, while the state with the lowest property crime rate was Massachusetts, with a rate of 1,179.8 per 100,000.^[85] However, Puerto Rico, an unincorporated territory of the United States, had a property crime rate of 702.7 per 100,000 in 2011.^[85]

Metropolitan areas

Crime in metropolitan statistical areas tends to be above the national average; however, wide variance exists among and within metropolitan areas.^[86] Some responding jurisdictions report very low crime rates, while others have considerably higher rates; these variations are due to many factors beyond population.^[86] FBI crime statistics publications strongly caution against comparison rankings of cities, counties, metropolitan statistical areas, and other reporting units without considering factors other than simply population.^[86] For 2011, the metropolitan statistical area with the highest violent crime rate was the Memphis metropolitan area, with a rate of 980.4 per 100,000 residents, while the metropolitan statistical area with the lowest violent crime rate was Logan metropolitan area, with a rate of 47.7.^{[87][88]}

It is quite common for crime in American cities to be highly concentrated in a few, often economically disadvantaged areas. For example, San Mateo County, California had a population of approximately 707,000 and 17 homicides in 2001. Six of these 17 homicides took place in poor East Palo Alto, which had a population of roughly 30,000. So, while East Palo Alto accounted for a mere 4.2% of the population, about one-third of the homicides took place there.^[89]

Crime in ten largest metropolitan areas (2011)^{[87][88]}

Metropolitan statistical area	Violent crime rate	Property crime rate
<u>New York-Northern New Jersey-Long Island, NY-NJ-PA MSA</u>	406.0	1744.1
<u>Los Angeles-Long Beach-Santa Ana, CA MSA</u>	405.4	2232.7
<u>Chicago-Joliet-Naperville, IL-IN-WI MSA</u>	357.2	2791.5
<u>Dallas-Fort Worth-Arlington, TX MSA</u>	358.4	3498.5
<u>Houston-Sugar Land-Baytown, TX MSA</u>	550.8	3576.9
<u>Philadelphia-Camden-Wilmington, PA-NJ-DE-MD MSA</u>	532.3	2747.3
<u>Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WV MSA</u>	334.6	2386.0
<u>Miami-Fort Lauderdale-Pompano Beach, FL MSA</u>	596.7	4193.3
<u>Atlanta-Sandy Springs-Marietta, GA MSA</u>	400.9	3552.0
<u>Boston-Cambridge-Quincy, MA-NH MSA</u>	374.7	2109.0

Number and growth of criminal laws

There are conflicting opinions on the number of federal crimes,^{[90][91]} but many have argued that there has been explosive growth and it has become overwhelming.^{[92][93][94]} In 1982, the U.S. Justice Department could not come up with a number, but estimated 3,000 crimes in the United States Code.^{[90][91][95]} In 1998, the American Bar Association (ABA) said that it was likely much higher than 3,000, but didn't give a specific estimate.^{[90][91]} In 2008, the Heritage Foundation published a report that put the number at a minimum of 4,450.^[91] When staff for a task force of the U.S. House Judiciary Committee asked the Congressional Research Service (CRS) to update its 2008 calculation of criminal offenses in the United States Code in 2013, the CRS responded that they lack the staffing and resources to accomplish the task.^[96]

See also

- Gangs in the United States
- Incarceration in the United States
- Mass shootings in the United States
- Race and crime in the United States
- National Crime Information Center Interstate Identification Index
- United States cities by crime rate
- List of U.S. states and territories by violent crime rate
- List of U.S. states and territories by intentional homicide rate
- Strict liability (criminal) § United States
- Contempt of court § United States
- List of criminal enterprises, gangs and syndicates § United States
- Illegal immigration to the United States and crime
- Terrorism in the United States

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Further reading

- Patrick Sharkey (2018). *Uneasy Peace: The Great Crime Decline, the Renewal of City Life, and the Next War on Violence*. ISBN 978-0393609608.
- Webster, DW & Vernick, JS (2013). *Reducing Gun Violence in America: Informing Policy with Evidence and Analysis*. ISBN 978-1421411101

External links

- 15 Most Wanted by U.S. Marshals (http://www.usmarshals.gov/investigations/most_wanted/index.html)
- The FBI's Ten Most Wanted Fugitives (<https://web.archive.org/web/20150504123612/http://www2.fbi.gov/wanted/topten/fugitives/fugitives.htm>)
- Surviving Crime (<http://www.shavemagazine.com/lifestyle/090501>)
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- DEA Fugitives, Major International Fugitives (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071012061558/http://www.dea.gov/fugitives/internl/internl1ist.htm>)
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- New York State's 100 Most Wanted Fugitives (<http://www.nysmostwanted.com/#>)
- All Most Wanted – official website of the Los Angeles Police Department (http://www.lapdonline.org/all_most_wanted)
- Nationmaster – Worldwide statistics (<http://www.nationmaster.com>)
- Open data on US violent crime (<https://archive.today/20130201035550/http://www.quandl.com/society/us-violent-crime>)

- [Top 10 cities in USA with lowest recorded crime rates \(http://www.elist10.com/top-10-cities-usa-lowest-recorded-crime-rates/\)](http://www.elist10.com/top-10-cities-usa-lowest-recorded-crime-rates/)
 - [U. S. Crime and Imprisonment Statistics Total and by State from 1960 – Current \(http://www.disastercenter.com/crime/\)](http://www.disastercenter.com/crime/)
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